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Enhancing Reconnaissance and Strike Capabilities for Allied Nations

29 - 30 September 2025

Hilton Kensington, London, UK



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- Hear the latest UAV Technology updates from **UK, European and International** Senior Leadership and Programme Managers
- **Engage and network** with senior programme leaders and decision-makers from across both military and industry and learn how to adapt your UAV platforms through innovation and experimentation
- **Discover a range of topics,** including UAV procurement, ISR capabilities, maritime operations, civil airspace integration, regulation and standardisation, and more
- Meet leading **industry solution providers** to discover how to leverage their UAV platforms and capabilities

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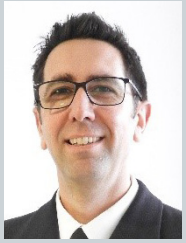
It is with a great sense of optimism that I invite you to join us for the 10th **UAV Technology Conference.** It's my privilege to serve as Chair this year, and I look forward to welcoming leaders and specialists from many nations, for what promises to be a key event at a time of significant geopolitical and technological transformation.

In 2025, UAVs are playing an exponentially more significant role than ever before. Across conflict zones, these systems are shaping outcomes not just on the ground, but at the strategic level. With airspace more contested than ever, the ability to use a blend of crewed and uncrewed systems and operate in contested environments is now a must.

At this year's conference, you'll hear from senior military decision-makers, key industry representatives, and international allies, all addressing the strategic and operational implications of this new uncrewed and autonomous era. The event will spotlight the surge in European defence spending, particularly around uncrewed systems, and provide programme updates from across the continent.

It's a pleasure to invite you to the conference. I'm eager to connect with all of you and truly hope that you find the experience as enriching as I know I will, thanks to your participation.

Warmest Regards,



Captain Ben Perkins-Brown,
Defence Engineering Champion and Head of Profession Engineering Team Leader,
DE&S, UK MoD

CHAIR:

Captain Ben Perkins-Brown, Defence Engineering Champion and Head of Profession Engineering Team Leader, **DE&S, UK MoD**

HOST NATION SPEAKERS INCLUDE:

Brigadier Stu Nasse, Head Capability Coalitions, **British Army HQ**

Group Captain Richard Long, RPAS – Protector International Lead, MICP Secretariat Hd, MQ-9B International Cooperation Programme (MICP), **Royal Air Force**

Group Captain Colin Welsh, Head RAF Rapid Capabilities Office, **Royal Air Force**

Group Captain Nick Robson, Deputy Head Regulation, **Military Aviation Authority**

Commander Ned Morgan, Carrier Strike & Maritime Aviation, SO1 RD&E - Develop Directorate, **Royal Navy**

Mr. James Gavin, Head of Future Capability Innovation, **DE&S, UK MoD**

INTERNATIONAL SPEAKERS INCLUDE:

Brigadier General John Creel, NATO ISR Force Commander, **NATO ISR Force**

Brigadier General Roman Hyťha, Director of the Intelligence Security Section of the MoD, **Czech Armed Forces**

Colonel Marco Santeramo, Director, Italian Remotely Piloted Aircraft Center of Excellence, **Italian Air Force**

Colonel Pavlo Khazan, Deputy Head of the Electronic Support Department of the General Directorate of Electronic and Cyber Warfare, **Armed Forces of Ukraine**

Lieutenant Colonel Daniel Boehm, Program Manager ADS 15, **Swiss Air Force**

Lieutenant Colonel Julien Letarte, Director – RPAS, **Royal Canadian Air Force**

Captain Johann Eidesheim, Commandant, Maritime Surveillance and Intervention Patrol Center of Expertise, **French Navy**

Mr. Crescenzo Esposito, MQ-9B Project Executive Officer, **NATO Support and Procurement Agency (NSPA)**

Dr. Joao Caetano, Project Officer UAS Programmes, **European Defence Agency**

Mr. Bernt-Erik Bergersen, UAV section manager - Procurements department, **Norwegian Defense Material Agency Air Systems**

Mr. Bertrand Riveill, Technical Programme Manager, **EUROCAE**

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UAV TECHNOLOGY CONFERENCE



Day One | Monday 29 September 2025

08.00 Registration & Coffee

08.50 Chair's Opening Remarks

Captain Ben Perkins-Brown, Defence Engineering Champion and Head of Profession Engineering Team Leader, **DE&S, UK MoD**

OPENING KEYNOTE BRIEFINGS

09.00 Drone Capability Coalition: Supporting Ukraine with Uncrewed Surveillance and Attack Capabilities

- Update on the work of the Drone Capability Coalition to support the Ukrainian Armed Forces
- Collaborating with international allies to rapidly field drones to Ukraine

Brigadier Stu Nasse, Head Capability Coalitions, **British Army HQ**

09.30 Uncrewed System Acquisition: Lessons Learned from the UK's Support of Ukraine and Emerging Demand Signals from the UK

- Key challenges and successes in rapid UAV acquisition and deployment
- Emerging UK defense requirements shaping future uncrewed system procurement

Mr. James Gavin, Head of Future Capability Innovation, **DE&S, UK MoD**

10.00 Session Reserved for Sponsor

10.30 Morning Coffee

ADVANCING PROCUREMENT TO ENHANCE OPERATIONS IN EASTERN EUROPE

11.00 Strengthening Ukraine's Military with Advanced Electromagnetic Warfare and Unmanned Systems Technologies: Overview of Lessons Learned from the Russian War in Ukraine

- Enhancing Ukraine's military power and capabilities with advanced UAV/UGV and C-UAV technology in the War against Russia
- Identifying threats to UAV and C-UAV operations
- Outlining future objectives for the continued evolution of Ukraine's Electromagnetic Warfare and Unmanned Systems capabilities

Colonel Pavlo Khazan, Deputy Head of the Electronic Support Department of the General Directorate of Electronic and Cyber Warfare, **Armed Forces of Ukraine**

11.30 Session Reserved for Sponsor

12.00 Unmanned Aerial Vehicles for the Czech Armed Forces: Insights and Lessons from the War in Ukraine

- Evolving defense strategies influenced by recent conflicts
- Strengthening and modernising UAV capabilities

Brigadier General Roman Hyťha, Director of the Intelligence Division of the General Staff, **Czech Armed Forces**

12.30 Session Reserved for Sponsor - Satcom Direct

13.00 Networking Lunch

MALE RPAS UPDATES

14.00 Advancing the MIC SP for Global Surveillance and Reconnaissance Capabilities

- NATO and International Partnerships for MQ-9
- Key opportunities and efficiencies
- Normalising MALE RPAS operations

Group Captain Richard Long, RPAS – Protector International Lead, MICP Secretariat Hd, MQ-9B International Cooperation Programme (MICP), **Royal Air Force**

14.30 Session Reserved for Sponsor

15.00 EUROCAE - The Use of Standards to Support RPAS

- Working-Group 105 on UAS
- Use case: ED-313 & ED-271A for MALE RPAS DAA
- Overview of standards
- What's next?

Dr. Bertrand Riveill, Technical Programme Manager, **EUROCAE**

15.30 Afternoon Tea

LEVERAGING UAS CAPABILITIES TO ADVANCE MARITIME OPERATIONS

16.00 Advancing UAS Capabilities in French Naval Operations

- Exploring the integration of UAS technologies to enhance surveillance, reconnaissance, and maritime security in French naval missions
- Assess operational challenges and strategic opportunities in deploying UAS across diverse naval environments
- What's next for French Naval UAS Capabilities?

Captain Johann Eidesheim, Commandant, Maritime Surveillance and Intervention Patrol Center of Expertise, **French Navy**

16.30 Royal Navy Maritime Aviation Transformation and the vision for uncrewed aviation

- Utilising a modular approach to optimise platform selection and iteration
- A digital pivot: Providing operational resilience for Navigation, Command & Autonomy
- Integrating crewed and uncrewed platforms effectively in a multinational hybrid environment

Commander Ned Morgan, Carrier Strike & Maritime Aviation, SO1 RD&E - Develop Directorate, **Royal Navy**

17.00 Chair's Closing Remarks and Close of Day One

Captain Ben Perkins-Brown, Defence Engineering Champion and Head of Profession Engineering Team Leader, **DE&S, UK MoD**

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UAV TECHNOLOGY CONFERENCE



Day Two | Tuesday 30 September 2025

08.00 **Registration & Coffee**

08.50 **Chair's Opening Remarks**
Captain Ben Perkins-Brown, Defence Engineering Champion and Head of Profession Engineering Team Leader, **DE&S, UK MoD**

OPENING KEYNOTE BRIEFINGS

09.00 **Deploying the RQ-4D Phoenix to Provide Rapid, Permanent and Long-Range Surveillance for NATO Members**
- Enabling rapid, permanent and long-range surveillance on land and at sea in all weather conditions with synthetic aperture radars (SAR)
- Providing the commanders of deployed forces with accurate and timely domain awareness
- Future plans for the NISRF following the 10-year anniversary

Brigadier General John Creel, NATO ISR Force Commander, **NATO ISR Force**

09.30 **RAF Rapid Capabilities Office: Leveraging Non-Traditional Approaches to Accelerate UAV Development**
- How the RAF Rapid Capabilities Office is adopting non-traditional methods to fast-track UAV development
- Examining recent successes and lessons learned in accelerating UAV capabilities from concept to operational deployment
- Discussing test and evaluation frameworks tailored to evolving UAV technologies and capabilities

Group Captain Colin Welsh, Head RAF Rapid Capabilities Office, **Royal Air Force**

10.00 **Session Reserved for Sponsor**

10.30 **Morning Coffee**

MILITARY AND CIVIL AIRSPACE INTEGRATION

11.00 **Unlocking UAV Integration: Navigating Challenges in Complex Airspace and Bridging Military and Civil Sectors**
- Discussing the UK's approach to UAV integration at all operational levels, including systems like Protector
- Addressing the shift from airspace segregation to integration in complex, congested airspace
- Examining how Defence's progress can unlock opportunities for the civil UAV sector

Group Captain Nick Robson, Deputy Head Regulation, **Military Aviation Authority**

11.30 **Session Reserved for Sponsor**

12.00 **Unlocking the Skies in Europe – Role of the European Defence Agency**
- Supporting integration of military operations across European airspace
- Coordinating joint efforts to enhance European airpower and interoperability
- Promoting common regulations and technical standards among member states

Mr. Joao Caetano, Project Officer UAS Programmes, **European Defence Agency**

12.30 **RPAS CoE: Enhancing Training and Capability for the Italian Armed Forces**
- Italian RPAS CoE mission
- Training for UAV pilots/operators
- UAS Operational Scenario - food for thought

Colonel Marco Santeramo, Director, Italian Remotely Piloted Aircraft Center of Excellence, **Italian Air Force**

13.00 **Networking Lunch**

ENHANCING UAV OPERATIONS IN ARCTIC ENVIRONMENTS

14.00 **UAV Procurements in NDMA Air Systems**
- Enhance the efficiency and effectiveness of UAV procurement processes
- Integrating emerging UAV technologies to meet evolving defence needs

Mr. Bernt-Erik Bergersen, UAV Section Manager - Procurements Department, **Norwegian Defense Material Agency Air Systems**

14.30 **Session Reserved for Sponsor**

15.00 **Advancing Royal Canadian Air Force Arctic RPAS Capabilities**
- Adapting MQ-9B Reaper for Arctic Operations
- Enhanced Arctic ISR Capabilities: UAVs will operate in polar and maritime regions, perform border surveillance, monitor large-scale events, support disaster response, reconnaissance missions, and precision strikes
- Expanding beyond surveillance: exploring additional roles for the uncrewed aircraft, including anti-submarine warfare (ASW), signals intelligence collection and airborne early warning

Lieutenant Colonel Julien Letarte, Director – RPAS, **Royal Canadian Air Force**

15.30 **Afternoon Tea**

FURTHER EUROPEAN PERSPECTIVES

16.00 **Evolving Partnerships, Expanding Applications, and the Rise of Versatile UAVs Through the NATO Support and Procurement Agency**
- How evolving partnerships within NATO are driving the development and deployment of versatile UAV technologies
- Integrating the MQ-9B into NATO operations to boost flexibility and interoperability
- Addressing regulatory frameworks to ensure seamless integration and compliance across NATO member states

Mr. Crescenzo Esposito, MQ-9B Project Executive Officer, **NATO Support and Procurement Agency (NSPA)**

16.30 **Challenges to bring ADS 15 into Operation**
- Personnel: maintaining know-how
- Processes: new capabilities
- Certification from an users perspective

Lieutenant Colonel Daniel Böhm, Program Manager ADS 15, **Swiss Air Force**

17.00 **Chair's Closing Remarks and Close of Day Two**
Captain Ben Perkins-Brown, Defence Engineering Champion and Head of Profession Engineering Team Leader, **DE&S, UK MoD**

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